



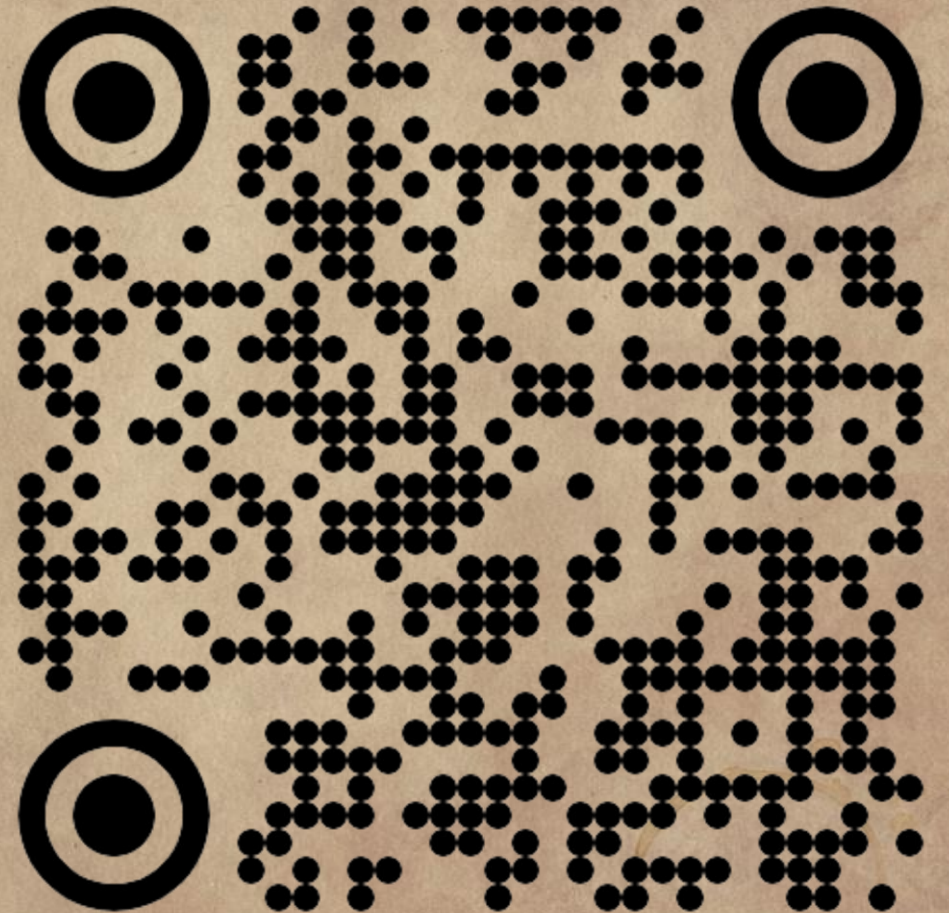
The Civil War Part 2

By Robert James

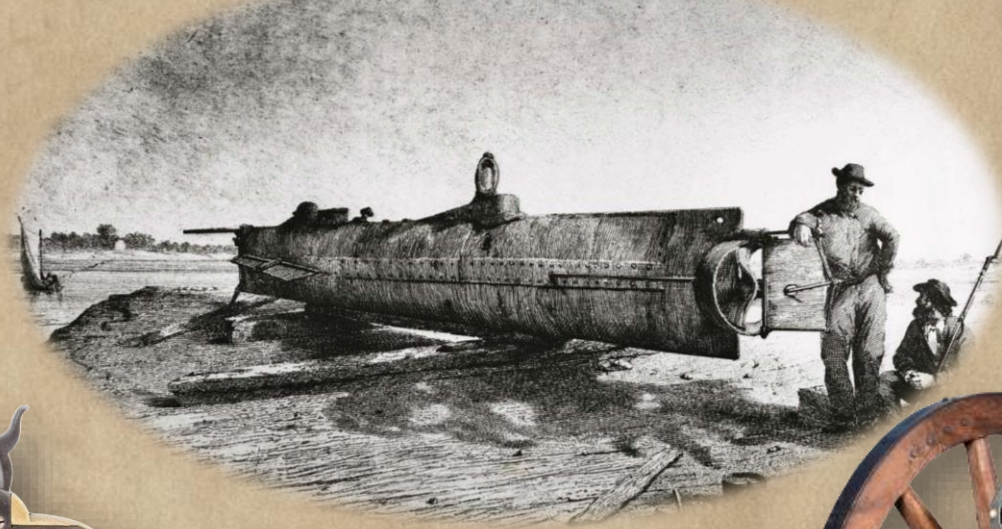


Presentation Materials

- **Scan this QR code to view the slide deck of this presentation and follow along!**
- **You can also find the recording of the previous presentation and accompanying materials!**



Last Presentation:
Battles, Weapons, Projectiles
and the Submarine CSS Hunley



Who is this man?

**Why is he in a Civil
War Presentation?**



“Old Blood and Guts”

- **War reduces mankind to the very lowest of human natures, for it decides who lives and who dies, in essence it forces all of its participants to live by the battlefield code of kill or be killed.**



Lt. General George S. Patton

“Old Blood and Guts”

- **In his own words, “The Object of War is not to die for your country, but to make the other bastard die for his.”**
- **In battle, nothing else really matters, for war is not just about who is RIGHT, it is also more about who is LEFT in the aftermath to rebuild and recover from the massive damage inflicted by the military of both sides on the civilian populations.**



Lt. General George S. Patton

The Civilian Impact

The Civil War and Civilian Impact

- Civilian populations faced economic chaos, starvation, and the loss of homes and family members.
- This was starkly seen during the siege of Vicksburg where residents ate rats and lived in caves.
- This presentation explores these varied impacts on civilians from both sides.



Siege of Vicksburg, May 18 – July 4, 1863

Funding the Fight: North vs. South

- **War costs must be covered by operating revenue or taxes.**
- **The conflict highlighted a massive economic inequity between the manufacturing North and the agrarian South.**

The South's "Cotton for Cash"



Cotton Farm, Civil War Era.

- **Lacking manufacturing, the South relied on selling cotton to English textile mills.**
- **England considered recognizing the Confederacy, but required proof that the South could militarily defend its secession first.**

The Union Blockade

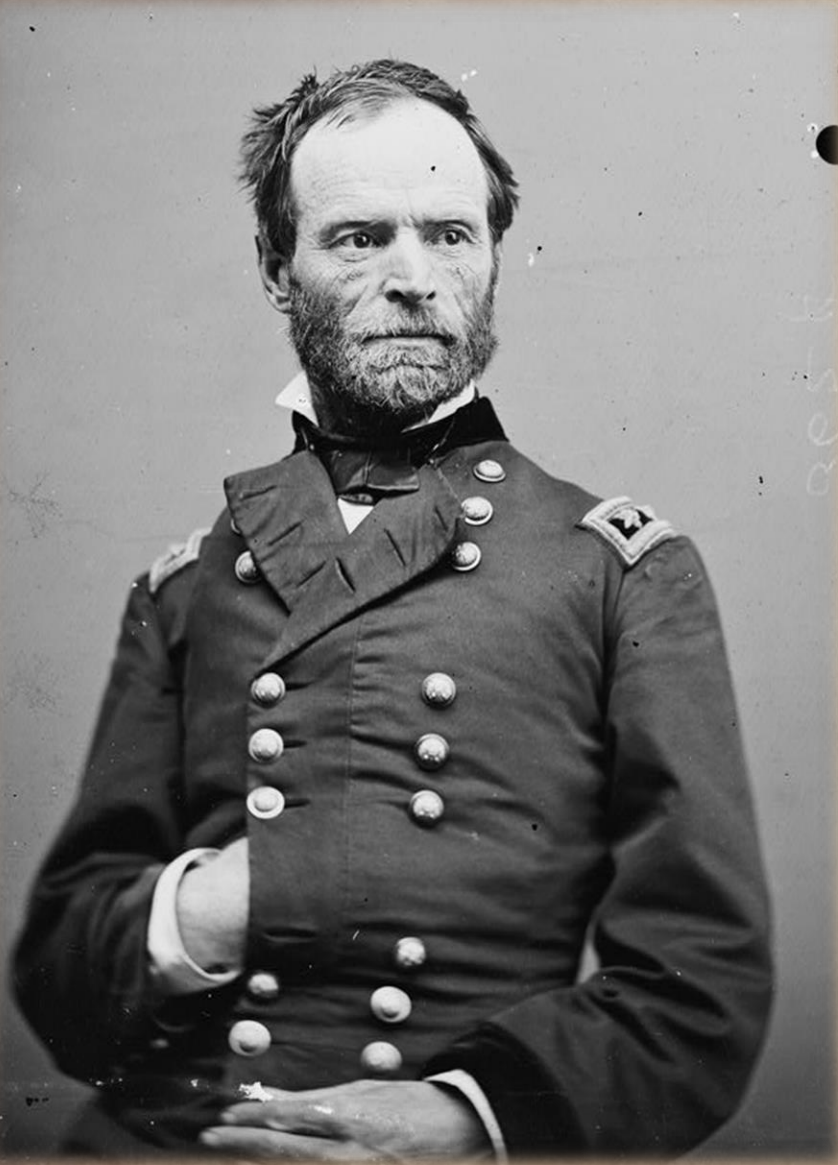
- After early Southern military successes, the Union realized they had to block cotton sales to win.
- The Union blockaded seacoast ports and seized control of the Mississippi River, causing England to back away from recognizing the Confederacy.



The Final Blow to King Cotton

- **Union successes against blockade runners and the major Confederate defeat at Gettysburg in 1863 killed the South's "King Cotton" funding strategy.**
- **This resulted in disaster and severe commodity shortages for Southern civilians.**

Questions?



William Tecumseh Sherman
Union General

• Sherman's "Collateral Damage" Strategy

- In 1864, Union General William Tecumseh Sherman proposed inflicting collateral damage on civilians to shorten the war.
- Union leadership determined that the South's fundamental ability to wage war had to be completely eradicated.

The Hard Hand of War

- Sherman's forces targeted infrastructure by tearing up railroads and eliminating food stores.
- The goal was to make civilians feel the privations of war so deeply that they would demand peace from Richmond.
- “We are not only fighting hostile armies, but a hostile people, and must make old and young, rich and poor, feel the hard hand of war,” Sherman wrote to General Henry W. Halleck in Washington.



Wrecking the Railroads in Atlanta

The March to Atlanta

- While the North viewed this as a just way to force surrender, the South saw it as cruelty and bullying.
- The strategy centered on destroying Atlanta, a major Confederate supply and industrial hub, to deny its resources to the enemy.



The Destruction of Atlanta

- Troops cut telegraph lines, demolished buildings with a custom battering-ram, and twisted iron rails into "Sherman's Neckties".



- Sherman strictly ordered that only business and industrial areas be burned, forbidding the torching of dwellings.

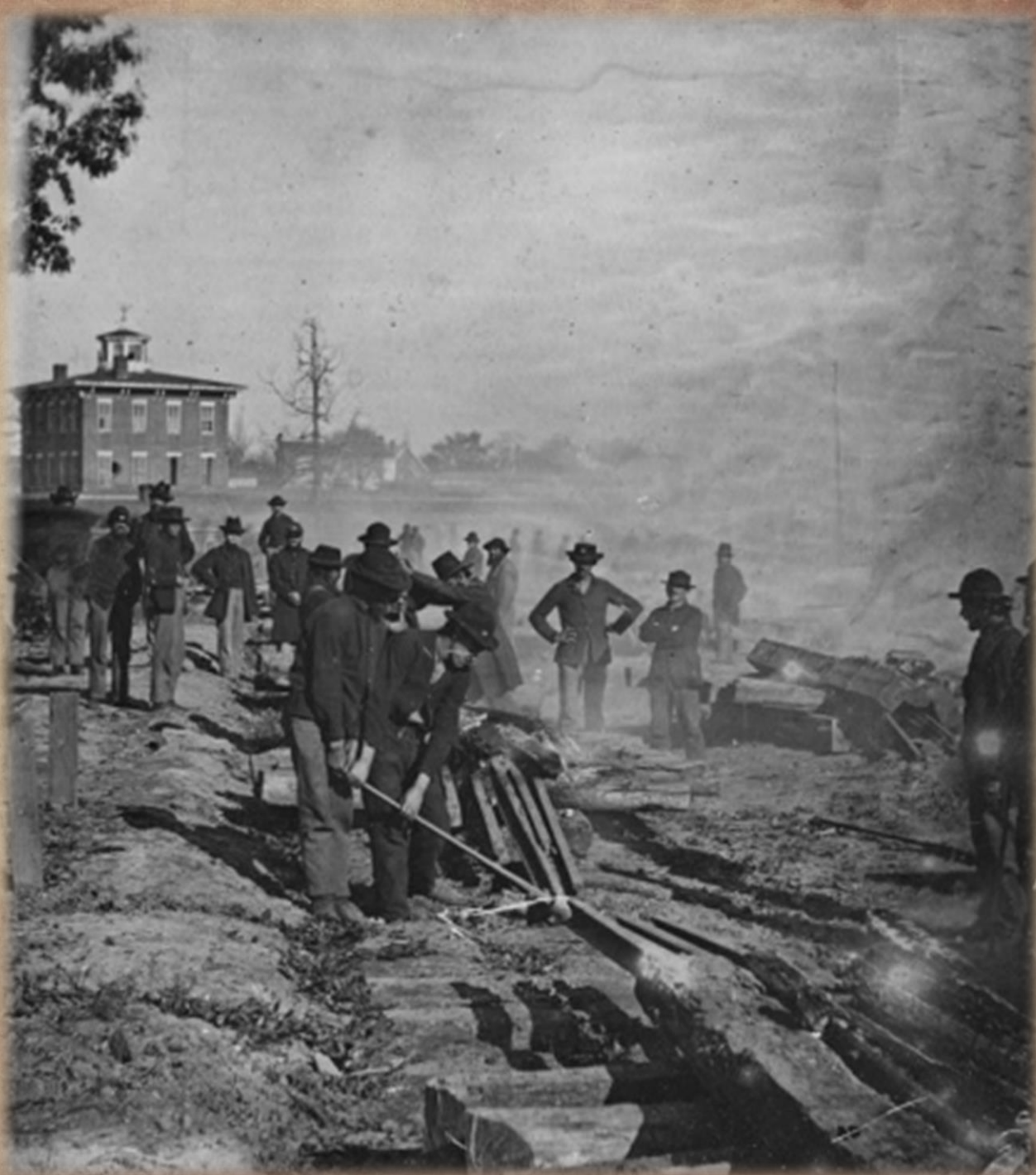
Fire and Looting

- Despite orders, civilian looters and some soldiers ransacked and burned homes, causing fires to spread into residential neighborhoods.



Sherman Neckties





Ephriam Ponder House

Exterior view of the heavily-damaged Ponder House, a large section of the building on the upper floor above the porch, having collapsed, after it was struck during shelling in the battle of Atlanta, 1864. Owned by slave trader Ephriam G. Ponder, the property is often referred to as the 'Potter House.'





Ruins of Roman Catholic Cathedral, interior view.
Charleston, South Carolina.



Children sit on a column of the Circular Church in
Charleston, South Carolina.



Photo from nature By G.N. Barnard.

RUINS OF THE R.R. DEPOT CHARLESTON S.C.



**"Destruction of Hood's Ordnance Train"
Atlanta, Georgia.**

Spreading the Destruction

- Sherman's army repeated this destruction across cities like Savannah, Columbia, and Charleston.
- Charleston faced near-total destruction as it was viewed as the birthplace of the rebellion.



Sherman's March to the Sea, 1868 by L. Stebbins

The Impact of Foraging



- Union troops heavily foraged for livestock, produce, and grain, plundering the South's meager resources and making civilian survival incredibly difficult.

Questions?

Impact of Foraging



Setting the Scene: Fall 1864

- Through careful, daily management of your land, you have managed to survive the hardships of war. Your family's survival relies entirely on your vegetable garden, carefully preserved fruits, and a small collection of livestock, including chickens, goats, and a milk cow.



The Arrival of the Foragers



- On a pleasant fall day, everything suddenly changes when a Union Army foraging party arrives. Acting on the direct orders of General William Tecumseh Sherman, the soldiers systematically seize your animals, fresh produce, and preserved winter foods. Even the hay and grain meant for your animals are taken to feed the Union cavalry and wagon teams.

How do you keep going?

In just a few short hours, your home and land are completely stripped of all the foodstuffs and forage you required to support your family through the coming winter. Faced with this devastating loss, what are your thoughts about the war, and how will you and your family survive?

Please take a couple of minutes to reflect and share your thoughts.

Questions?

Financing the War

Northern Financial Struggles

- The Union had manufacturing capabilities but lacked the cash to pay troops and factories.
- Fearing hard times, Northern civilians hoarded gold, silver, and copper coins.



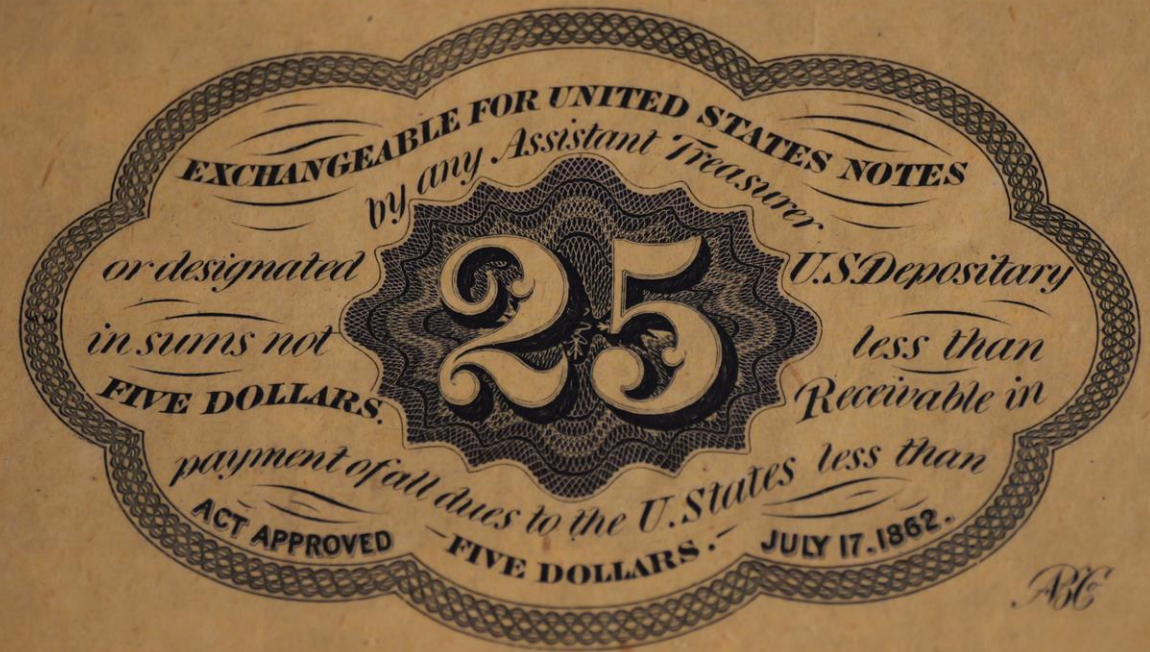
Northern Financial Struggles

- The hoarding of Government issued coins, prompted merchants to issue "store" and "patriotic" tokens.



Fractional Currency

- The Federal Government issued unpopular paper "fractional currency" to replace missing coins.



Encased Postage Stamps

- Some businesses used encased postage stamps.



Newly Designed Coins



Questions?

Pre-War Mint Expansion

- **Prior to 1835, all United States coinage was produced exclusively at the Philadelphia Mint.**
- **On March 3, 1835, Congress authorized three new branch mints: New Orleans, LA; Charlotte, NC; and Dahlonega, GA.**
- **The Charlotte and Dahlonega branches were specifically built to process newly discovered local gold, eliminating the risk and delay of transporting it to Philadelphia.**
- **By the onset of the Civil War, the New Orleans mint had become the nation's second-largest producer of high-denomination gold and silver coins.**

Seizure of the Mints

- **Seceding states seized the Federal Branch Mints located within their territories.**
- **The seized assets, including valuable supplies of bullion, were turned over to the new Confederate National Government.**
- **A March 1861 estimate revealed the mints would cost far more to operate than the income they would produce.**

Closure of the Confederate Mints

- **The Confederate Congress suspended operations to ensure public services remained self-sustaining.**
- **The New Orleans Mint's copper supply was eventually handed over to Louisiana to manufacture percussion caps for militia guns.**

The Confederate Currency Crisis

- By 1862, having exhausted their minted bullion, the Confederacy faced an extreme shortage of gold, silver, and copper coinage.
- They were forced to rely on pre-war Union coins and whatever precious little currency could be sneaked in by smugglers and blockade runners.

The Confederate Currency Crisis

- To compensate for the shortage, the government and local banks printed unbacked paper Bank Notes, which quickly sparked bank failures.



The Confederate Currency Crisis

- Merchants, farmers, and military suppliers soon refused to accept this near-worthless paper money as payment for goods.



Union Financial Struggles

- **The Union faced its own financial crisis in 1862, exacerbated by fearful civilians hoarding hard currency like gold, silver, and pennies.**
- **This severe hoarding hampered the Union's ability to obtain funds to support the war effort against the South.**

The Union Tax Stamp Solution

- **The Lincoln Administration implemented a highly successful tax stamp program on ordinary legal papers and everyday products to raise funds.**
- **Stamps ranging from 1 cent to over \$3 provided steady revenue to help clear war debt without feeling overly burdensome to the public.**

U.S. Civil War Revenue Tax Stamp Types

- Agreement
- Bank Check
- Bill of Lading
- Certificate
- Conveyance
- Entry of Goods
- Foreign Exchange
- Inland Exchange
- Insurance Policy
- Internal Revenue
- Lease
- Manifest
- Mortgage
- Original Process
- Passage Ticket
- Playing Cards
- Power of Attorney
- Proprietary
- Surety Bond
- Telegraph
- Will

Tax Stamps







Aurora, Ind., *Jan 18* 186 *5*

Received of **O. P. COBB & CO.**

Three Hundred Thirty Seven & 62 Dollars,
in full for Hay *John D. Schenberger*
100



No 91 *Jersey City, Jan 23 1868*
Second National Bank
Pay to the order of *Schneider & Schmidt*
Sixteen Dollars
\$16.00 *James H. Dederer*



Questions?

Carte de Viste's

Taxing Photography (Cartes de Visite)

- Photography boomed during this era, popularizing inexpensive 2x3 inch "Cartes de Visite" (calling cards) featuring portraits of families and soldiers.
- These highly sought-after photographic novelties were subject to a 1 to 3 cent tax stamp.



BARCALOW,
76 Bowery,
N. Y.

Duplicates of this Picture can be had at
any time.



CHAMBERLIN,
NORWICH,
N. Y.

PHOTOGRAPHED BY
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BARCLOW,
76 Bowery,
N Y

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L. B. Case

3⁵⁰



CHAMBERLIN,
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CHARLES E. ROGERS,
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Questions?

The Postal War

The Postal War (Part 1 - Union)

- **Fearing the South would use their existing stockpile of US stamps for postage, the Union completely demonetized all current stamps.**
- **They immediately printed a new series of stamps to officially invalidate the old designs.**

The Postal War (Part 2 - Confederacy)

- **The Confederacy printed their own stamps to prevent Union sympathizers from using the mail to distribute northern propaganda.**
- **Lacking engraved steel plates, early Confederate stamps were of much poorer quality than their Union counterparts.**

Confederate Stamps



CONFEDERATE STATES POSTAGE

1861-62

Union Stamps



Head-Quarters, Army of the Potomac,

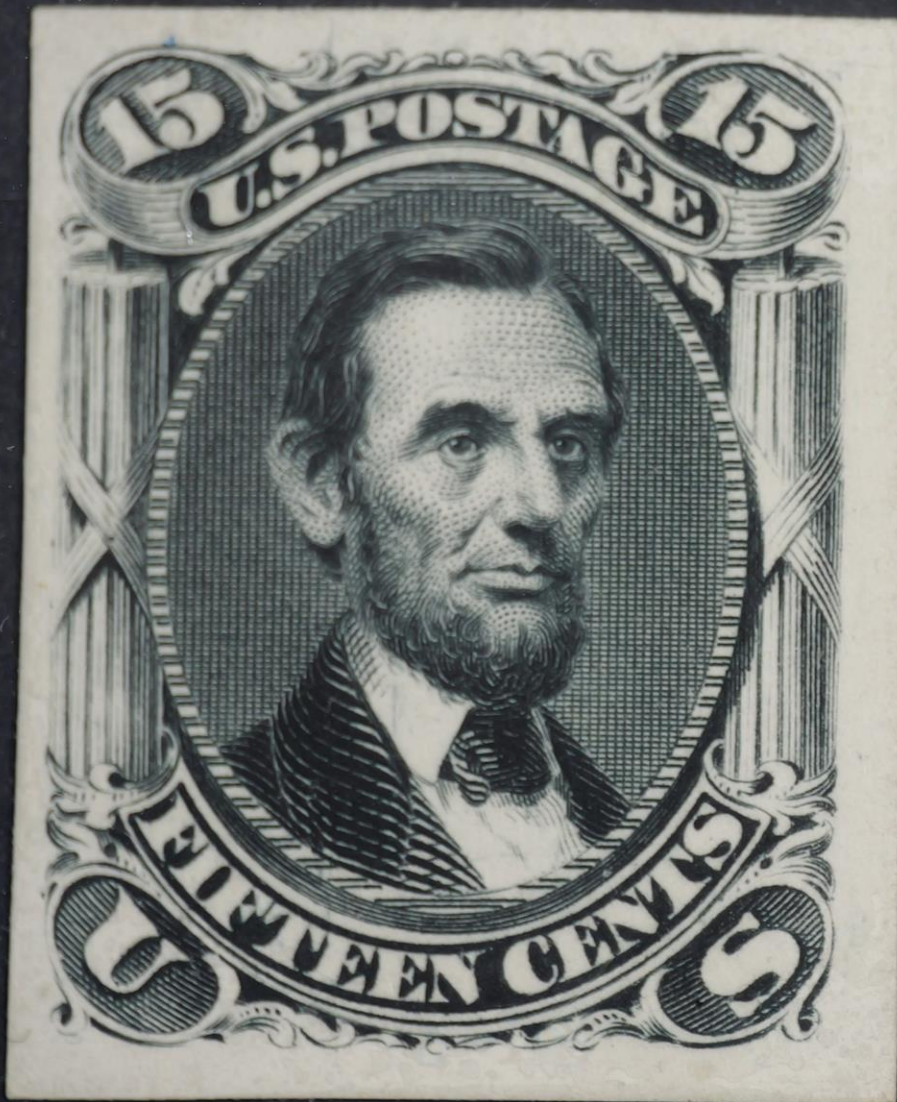


T. P. Madden, Esq.,
San Francisco,
California

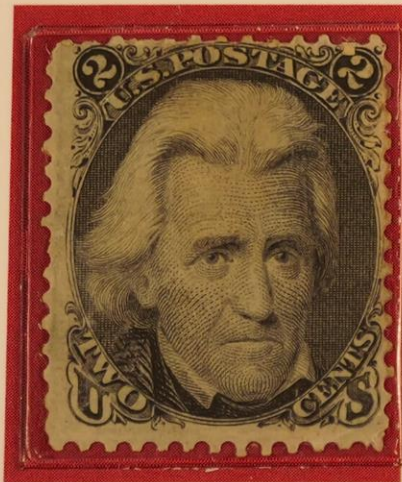


PRIVATE FIRM US POSTAGE STAMP

1862

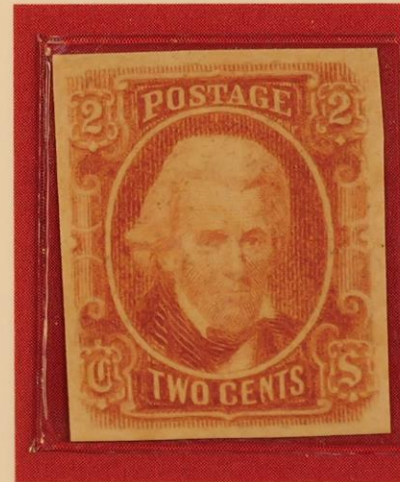


United States
Two-cent
Andrew Jackson



First Known Use
July 6, 1863

Confederate States
Two-cent
Andrew Jackson



First Known Use
April 21, 1863

Questions?

The Saga of the SS Republic: The Ship with Three Lives



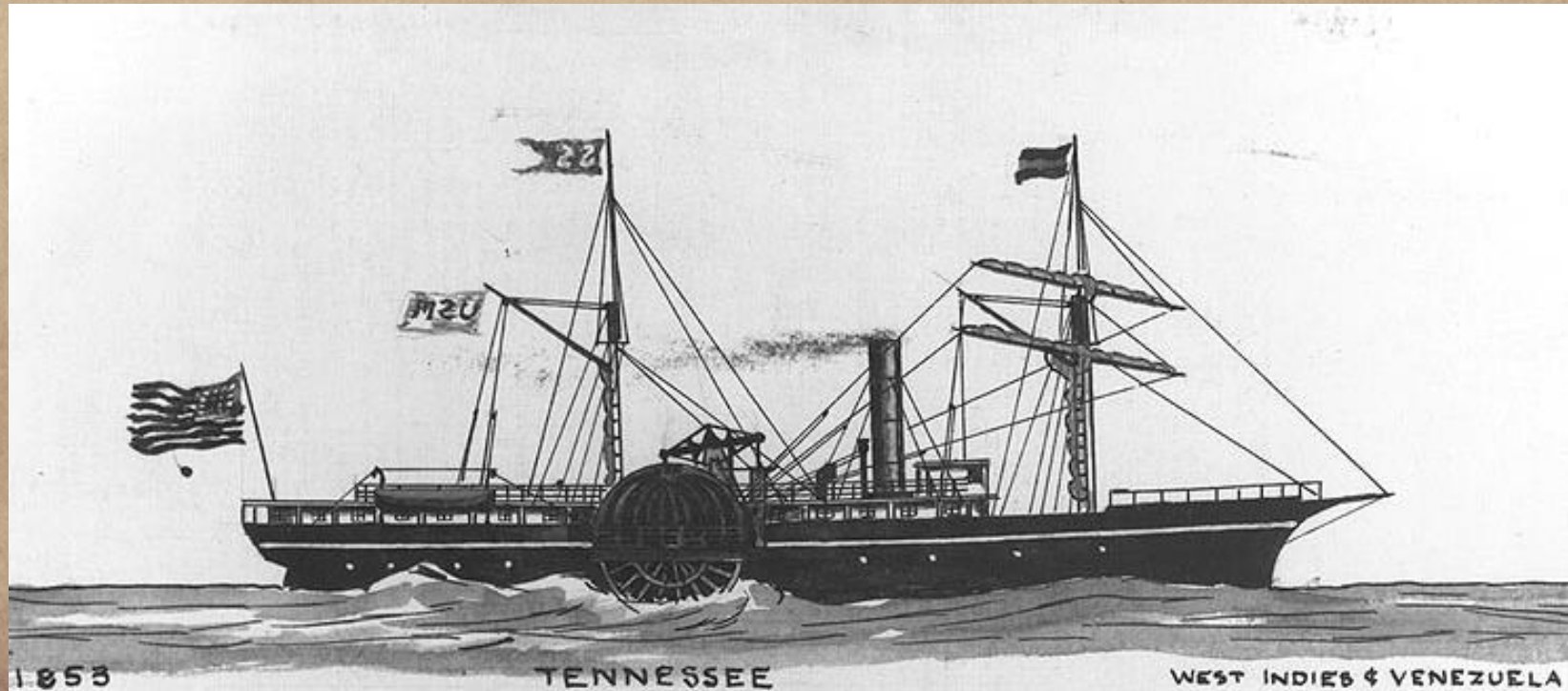
Question: What is a “Carpet Bagger?”

Opportunists of the South

- **Carpetbaggers were Northern citizens who packed their belongings in cheap luggage made of carpet remnants and headed South after the war.**
- **Also known as "scalawags," they sought to buy up southern land and goods for pennies on the dollar, capitalizing on the misery of survivors.**

The SS Tennessee (Origins)

- Built in Baltimore and christened the SS Tennessee in 1853, she was an industrial marvel of her time.
- The 210-foot ship featured massive 28-foot iron sidewheels, accommodating 100 passengers and 5,000 barrels of cargo.



The SS Tennessee (Early Years)

- **Before the Civil War, the ship had several marginally profitable stints as a passenger and cargo vessel.**
- **Her early routes included trips to France, transporting miners to the California gold fields, and carrying soldiers to Nicaragua.**

A Ship of War

- Impounded by the Confederacy as a blockade runner, she was eventually captured by Union forces at New Orleans.
- Refitted as a well-armed Union warship, she served as Admiral David Farragut's flagship in several battles, including Mobile Bay.

Rebirth as the SS Republic

- **After gale damage ended her military service, a New York shipping magnate purchased the crippled hull in 1865 and renamed her the SS Republic.**
- **Following an extensive refit, she began regular runs to New Orleans, carrying cargo and currency to fuel the city's expanding post-war economy.**
- **She steamed out of New York on October 18, 1865, on what would be her final voyage—Mother Nature's intervention would soon ruin the plans of Northern investors aboard, who were hoping to use this voyage to profit heavily off the war-wrecked Southern economy.**

A Cargo of Relief and Profit

- The ship's manifest included vital philanthropic aid: school supplies, bottled medicines, wines, and preserves to feed the hungry in New Orleans parishes.
- Northern church groups also sent religious supplies to help rebuild and furnish southern churches devastated by the war.



The Investors' Treasure

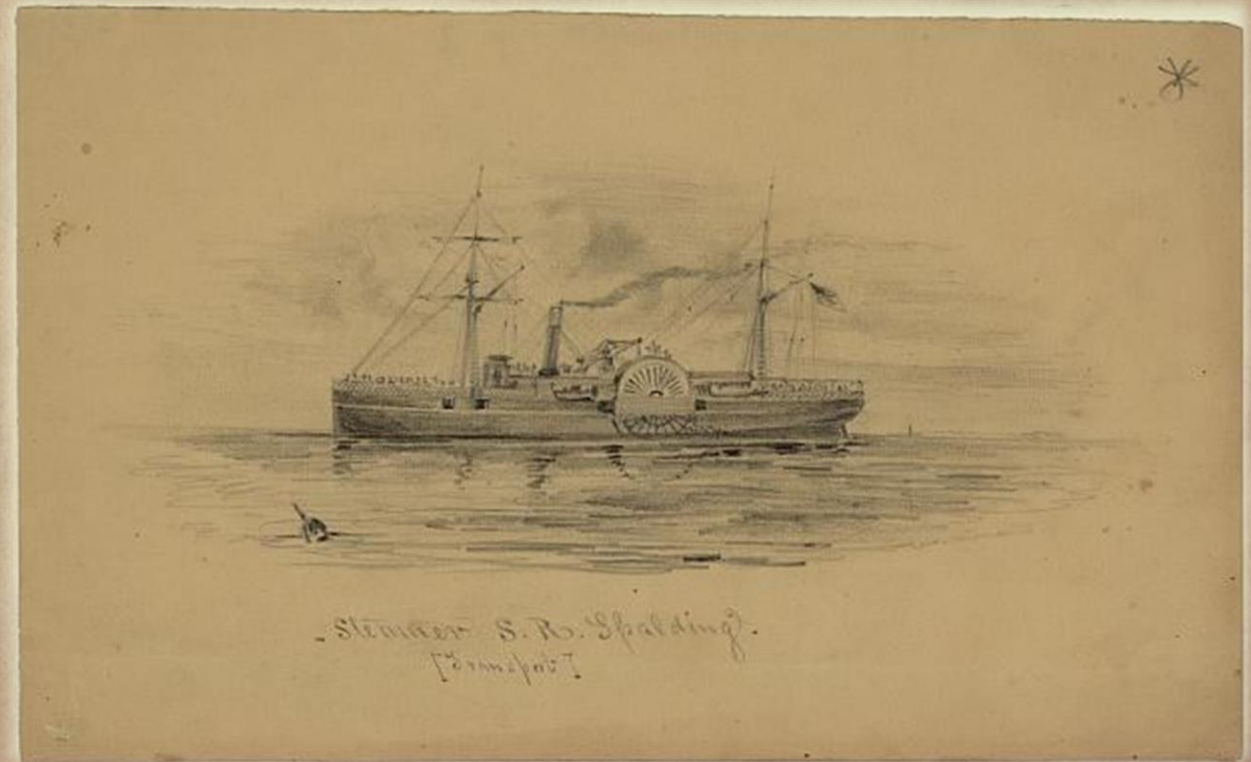
- **Hidden among the relief supplies was a massive shipment of gold and silver specie totaling over \$400,000.**
- **This treasure belonged to Northern investors—carpetbaggers on a grand scale—planning to purchase choice Southern land.**

Caught in the Hurricane

- **Five days after leaving New York, the Republic was caught and stalled without power in a fierce hurricane.**
- **Despite passengers laboring for hours to bail the hold, the ship began to succumb to the sea.**

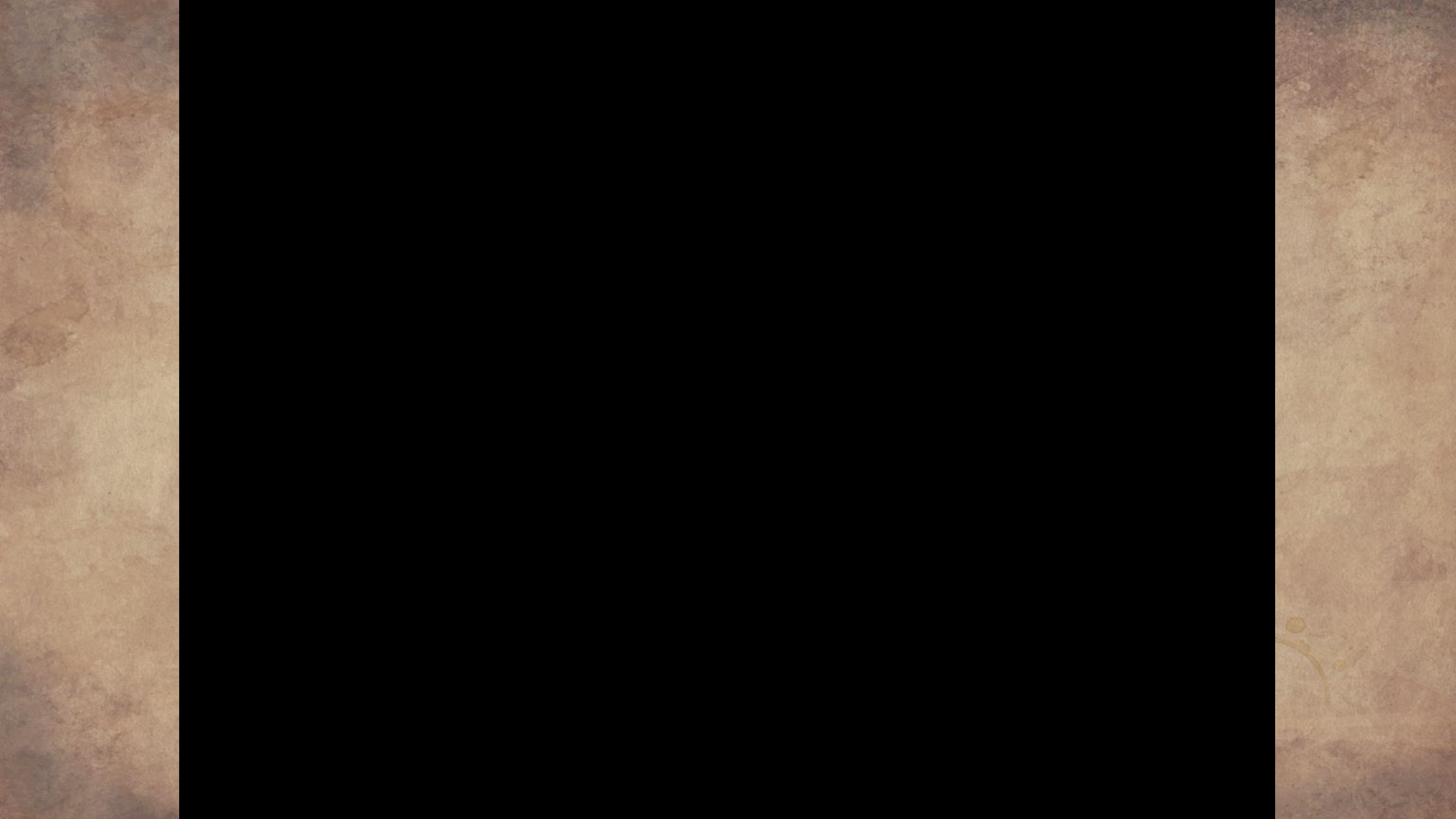
The Sinking of the Republic

- The crew worked feverishly in the final moments to prepare lifeboats and makeshift rafts for the survivors.
- At 4:00 PM on October 25th, the SS Republic sank 1,700 feet to the ocean floor, taking her \$400,000 treasure with her.



Rediscovery & Recovery

- **We will now look at survivor accounts and the eventual partial recovery of the ship's cargo by Odyssey Marine Exploration.**



The SS Republic

- **The fateful end of the SS Republic unexpectedly impacted both the North and the South.**
- **Mother Nature intervened at a time when her cargo represented both salvation for the desperate and exploitation by opportunists.**

“Treasure” of the SS Republic



“Treasure” of the SS Republic



“Treasure” of the SS Republic



“Treasure” of the SS Republic



Thank you for attending!